

Reviewer Pack — Free 4-Cumulant Excess Capped by Stable Rank Lower-Bounds $R(\dots)$

Entry 9b585cab1475 · INCONCLUSIVE

SEC autonomous research engine — attribution: Ludovico Kubler

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Free 4-Cumulant Excess Capped by Stable Rank Lower-Bounds $R(\text{DISJ})$

Entry ID: 9b585cab1475 **Verdict:** INCONCLUSIVE **Recorded:** 2026-05-18 23:39:26 UTC

1. Conjecture

Field A (mathematical branch): Free probability — free cumulants κ_k of empirical squared-singular-value spectra via Möbius inversion over the non-crossing partition lattice $\text{NC}(k)$, in the Voiculescu 1985 / Speicher 1994 / Nica-Speicher 2006 tradition. An arXiv search for ‘free cumulant’ AND (‘disjointness’ OR ‘randomized communication complexity’ OR ‘gamma_2 norm’) returns 0 direct hits with <5 adjacent papers (all on free-probabilistic SDP relaxations of Max-Cut or on free Plancherel asymptotics — never on the squared-singular-value spectrum of a Boolean sign matrix as a CC lower bound). Distinct from blacklisted Bourgain-Tzafriri sub-column dispersion (column-subset operator norms), Halász L^2 spectrum discrepancy (CDF deviation), Matoušek det-LB (max-of-submatrix determinants), Kashin L^1 -flatness (single-eigenvector L^1/L^2 ratio), and from the Mahler-measure bivariate sign-polynomial attempt (a complex-analytic single-number functional). The functional uses a Schatten-2/4 ratio plus an operator-norm cap (sup), neither of which extends to a polynomial F_q lift of the Boolean ring, so the bridge is Aaronson-Wigderson algebrization-safe. **Field B** (complexity object): Randomized two-party communication complexity $R_{1/3}(M)$ of $\{0,1\}$ sign matrices, target $M_{\{\text{DISJ}_n\}}$ on $N=2^n$ (Razborov 1992 $\Omega(n)$ regime). Linked to $\text{PROOF_COMPLEXITY_EXT_FREGE}$ via Krajíček’s feasible-interpolation theorem: EF refutations of split tautologies yield two-party CC protocols, so a CC lower bound $\tau(M_{\{\text{DISJ}_n\}})=\Omega(n)$ translates into an EF depth lower bound for the canonical Razborov interpolation tautology.

Statement:

Let $M \in \{0,1\}^{\{N \times N\}}$ with $N \geq 4$ and define the rescaled spectral moments $s_k := \text{tr}((MM^T)^k)/N^{k+1}$ for $k=1,2,3,4$, the 2nd and 4th free cumulants $\kappa_2(M) := s_2 - s_1^2$ and $\kappa_4(M) := s_4 - 4s_1s_3 - 2s_2^2 + 10s_1^2s_2 - 5s_1^4$, and the stable rank $\text{sr}(M) := \text{tr}(MM^T)/\|M\|_{\text{op}}^2$. Set the bridge invariant $\tau(M) := \min\{\log_2(1 + |\kappa_4(M)|/(\kappa_2(M)^2 + N^{-2})), \log_2(\text{sr}(M))\}$. Conjecture: there is an absolute constant $c \geq 0.05$ such that the 1/3-error randomized two-party communication complexity satisfies $R(M) \geq c \cdot \tau(M)$ for every $\{0,1\}$ matrix M , and $\tau(M_{\{\text{DISJ}_n\}}) \geq 0.15 \cdot n$ for every $n \geq 4$.

Rationale (proposer’s reasoning):

Free cumulants linearize the multiplicative Kronecker structure $M_{\{\text{DISJ}_n\}} = M_1^{\{\otimes n\}}$ ($M_1 = [[1,1],[1,0]]$ with golden-ratio singular values $\phi, 1/\phi$): the squared-SV spectrum is a product measure, so $\log(|\kappa_4|/\kappa_2^2)$ grows exactly linearly in n ($\approx 0.63n$), faithfully tracking the Razborov $\Omega(n)$ bound. Capping by $\log_2(\text{sr})$ is essential to

block rank-1 / low-rank trivializations (the all-ones matrix has $\kappa_4 \sim N^3$ yet $R = 0$, but $sr = 1$), and the cap simultaneously evades the Razborov-Rudich natural-proofs trap because τ is small on random Boolean functions ($\kappa_k \rightarrow 1$ for the Marchenko-Pastur limit). Replacing the Linial-Shraibman γ_2 SDP with an explicit $O(N^3)$ free-cumulant moment computation opens a 30-LOC Lean target where each tensor factor contributes additively.

Taxonomy category: PROOF_COMPLEXITY_EXT_FREG (status at proposal time: alive)

2. Pre-registration (Popper-style)

Hash (SHA-256 prefix): e7e0862eb689a01a

This hash commits to the conjecture statement, acceptance criterion, and seed list **before** the empirical test runs. Tampering with the test or its data after this hash was computed would be detectable.

Acceptance criterion:

Across all tested instances (DISJ for $n=2..9$, 30 random ± 1 sign matrices per $N=4..512$, low-rank decoys at $N=128$ with $k \in \{1,2,4,8,16,32\}$, and Hadamard/IP₂ at $N \in \{16,64,256\}$), the DISJ bound $\tau(M_{\{\text{DISJ}_n\}}) \geq 0.15 \cdot n$ must hold for every n , AND no non-DISJ instance may have $0.05 \cdot \tau(M)$ exceed $\min(\lceil \log_2 N \rceil + 1, \lceil \log_2 \text{rank}(M) \rceil + 2)$. Support requires $\geq 95\%$ of seeds within each (family, N) cell to satisfy both, with all 8 DISJ values satisfying the linear bound.

3. Barrier filter (F1)

Final: PASS

Barrier	Verdict	Confidence	LLM ₁	LLM ₂
RELATIVIZATION	SAFE	0.92	SAFE	SAFE
NATURAL PROOFS	SAFE	0.78	SAFE	SAFE
ALGEBRIZATION	SAFE	0.78	SAFE	SAFE
KARP_LIPTON	SAFE	0.90	SAFE	SAFE

4. Novelty audit

Verdict: NOVEL against 9 hits across arXiv + Semantic Scholar + ECCC

Search queries (3): - free cumulants singular value spectrum communication complexity lower bound - stable rank Schatten norm randomized communication complexity disjointness - non-crossing partition spectral moments sign matrix γ_2 norm

Top relevant hits considered: - [http://arxiv.org/abs/cs/0111062v2] One-way communication complexity and the Neciporuk lower bound on formula size - [http://arxiv.org/abs/2207.14810v3] Simplifying a classical-quantum algorithm interpolation with quantum singular value transformations - [http://arxiv.org/abs/cs/9906008v2] A Lower Bound on the Average-Case Complexity of Shellsort - [http://arxiv.org/abs/1403.8106v1] Recent advances on the log-rank conjecture in communication complexity - [http://arxiv.org/abs/2004.12646v3] Input-Sparsity Low Rank Approximation in Schatten Norm - [http://arxiv.org/abs/1608.06580v2] Communication complexity of approximate Nash equilibria - [http://arxiv.org/abs/1706.00529v3] Generalized non-crossing Partitions and Buildings - [http://arxiv.org/abs/1201.4669v3] On maximal chains in the non-crossing partition lattice

5. Empirical test harness

Multi-seed protocol: 5 seeds (11, 23, 37, 53, 71)

Sandbox: isolated subprocess, stdlib-only, $\leq 90s$ wall time per cycle **Execution:** rc=1, elapsed=0.1s

5.1 Generated Python source

```
import random
import math
from fractions import Fraction

def run_trial(seed: int) -> dict:
    random.seed(seed)

    def matrix_multiply(A, B):
        return [[sum(a * b for a, b in zip(row_a, col_b)) for col_b in zip(*B)] for row_a in A]

    def matrix_power(M, k):
        result = M
        for _ in range(1, k):
            result = matrix_multiply(result, M)
        return result

    def trace(matrix):
        return sum(matrix[i][i] for i in range(len(matrix)))

    def frobenius_norm(matrix):
        return math.sqrt(sum(sum(x**2 for x in row) for row in matrix))

    def power_iteration(B, num_steps=50):
        v = [random.random() for _ in range(len(B))]
        v /= frobenius_norm(v)
        for _ in range(num_steps):
            v = matrix_multiply(B, v)
            v /= frobenius_norm(v)
        return v

    def log2(x):
        if x <= 0:
            return float('-inf')
        return math.log2(x)

    def free_cumulant_4(M):
        B = matrix_multiply(M, M)
        B2 = matrix_multiply(B, B)
        B3 = matrix_multiply(B2, B)

        s1 = trace(B) / len(M)**2
        s2 = frobenius_norm(B)**2 / len(M)**3
        s3 = trace(matrix_multiply(B2, B)) / len(M)**4
        s4 = frobenius_norm(B2)**2 / len(M)**5

        kappa_2 = s2 - s1**2
        kappa_4 = s4 - 4 * s1 * s3 - 2 * s2**2 + 10 * s1**2 * s2 - 5 * s1**4

        return kappa_4

    def stable_rank(M):
        B = matrix_multiply(M, M)
        eigenvector = power_iteration(B)
        sigma_1 = sum(eigenvector[i]**2 for i in range(len(eigenvector)))
        return trace(B) / (sigma_1 * frobenius_norm(B))
```

```

def bridge_invariant(M):
    kappa_4 = free_cumulant_4(M)
    sr = stable_rank(M)
    term1 = log2(abs(kappa_4) / (kappa_2**2 + len(M)**(-2)))
    term2 = log2(sr)
    return min(term1, term2)

def generate_disj_matrix(n):
    M1 = [[1, 1], [1, 0]]
    result = M1
    for _ in range(1, n):
        result = matrix_multiply(result, M1)
    return result

def generate_random_sign_matrix(N):
    return [[random.choice([-1, 1]) for _ in range(N)] for _ in range(N)]

def generate_low_rank_decoy(N, k):
    u = [random.random() for _ in range(k)]
    v = [random.random() for _ in range(k)]
    return [[u[i] * v[j] for j in range(N)] for i in range(N)]

def generate_hadamard_matrix(N):
    if N == 1:
        return [[1]]
    H_half = generate_hadamard_matrix(N // 2)
    H = [[0] * N for _ in range(N)]
    for i in range(N // 2):
        for j in range(N // 2):
            H[i][j] = H_half[i][j]
            H[i][j + N // 2] = H_half[i][j]
            H[i + N // 2][j] = H_half[i][j]
            H[i + N // 2][j + N // 2] = -H_half[i][j]
    return H

def generate_ip2_matrix(N):
    if N == 1:
        return [[1]]
    I = [[0] * N for _ in range(N)]
    for i in range(N):
        I[i][i] = 1
    J = [[0] * N for _ in range(N)]
    for i in range(N):
        for j in range(N):
            if i != j:
                J[i][j] = 1
    return matrix_multiply(I, J)

def communication_complexity_upper_bound(M):
    rank_M = sum(1 for row in M if any(x != 0 for x in row))
    return max(math.ceil(math.log2(len(M))), math.ceil(math.log2(rank_M))) + 2

def run_disj_trial(n):
    M = generate_disj_matrix(n)
    tau = bridge_invariant(M)

```

```

cc_upper_bound = communication_complexity_upper_bound(M)
if tau < 0.15 * n or 0.05 * tau > cc_upper_bound:
    return {"metric_name": "tau", "metric_value": tau, "instances_tested": 1, "conjecture_holds": True}
return {"metric_name": "tau", "metric_value": tau, "instances_tested": 1, "conjecture_holds": False}

def run_random_trial(N):
    M = generate_random_sign_matrix(N)
    tau = bridge_invariant(M)
    cc_upper_bound = communication_complexity_upper_bound(M)
    if 0.05 * tau > min(math.ceil(math.log2(N)), math.ceil(math.log2(rank_M))) + 2:
        return {"metric_name": "tau", "metric_value": tau, "instances_tested": 1, "conjecture_holds": True}
    return {"metric_name": "tau", "metric_value": tau, "instances_tested": 1, "conjecture_holds": False}

def run_low_rank_trial(N, k):
    M = generate_low_rank_decoy(N, k)
    tau = bridge_invariant(M)
    cc_upper_bound = communication_complexity_upper_bound(M)
    if 0.05 * tau > min(math.ceil(math.log2(N)), math.ceil(math.log2(rank_M))) + 2:
        return {"metric_name": "tau", "metric_value": tau, "instances_tested": 1, "conjecture_holds": True}
    return {"metric_name": "tau", "metric_value": tau, "instances_tested": 1, "conjecture_holds": False}

def run_hadamard_trial(N):
    M = generate_hadamard_matrix(N)
    tau = bridge_invariant(M)
    cc_upper_bound = communication_complexity_upper_bound(M)
    if 0.05 * tau > min(math.ceil(math.log2(N)), math.ceil(math.log2(rank_M))) + 2:
        return {"metric_name": "tau", "metric_value": tau, "instances_tested": 1, "conjecture_holds": True}
    return {"metric_name": "tau", "metric_value": tau, "instances_tested": 1, "conjecture_holds": False}

def run_ip2_trial(N):
    M = generate_ip2_matrix(N)
    tau = bridge_invariant(M)
    cc_upper_bound = communication_complexity_upper_bound(M)
    if 0.05 * tau > min(math.ceil(math.log2(N)), math.ceil(math.log2(rank_M))) + 2:
        return {"metric_name": "tau", "metric_value": tau, "instances_tested": 1, "conjecture_holds": True}
    return {"metric_name": "tau", "metric_value": tau, "instances_tested": 1, "conjecture_holds": False}

results = []
for n in range(2, 10):
    results.append(run_disj_trial(n))

for N in [4, 8, 16, 32, 64, 128, 256]:
    for _ in range(30):
        results.append(run_random_trial(N))

for N in [128]:
    for k in [1, 2, 4, 8, 16, 32]:
        results.append(run_low_rank_trial(N, k))

for N in [16, 64, 256]:
    results.append(run_hadamard_trial(N))
    results.append(run_ip2_trial(N))

tau_disj_values = [result["metric_value"] for result in results if "tau" in result and result["conjecture_holds"] == True]
cc_upper_bounds = [communication_complexity_upper_bound(generate_random_sign_matrix(N)) for N in range(2, 10)]

```

```

mean_tau = sum(tau_disj_values) / len(tau_disj_values)
std_tau = math.sqrt(sum((x - mean_tau)**2 for x in tau_disj_values) / len(tau_disj_values))
support_fraction = sum(result["conjecture_holds"] for result in results if "tau" in result and

if all(0.15 * n <= tau for n, tau in zip(range(2, 10), tau_disj_values)):
    if support_fraction >= 0.95:
        print(f"RESULT: SUPPORTED mean={mean_tau} std={std_tau} support_fraction={support_fraction}")
    else:
        print(f"RESULT: INCONCLUSIVE support_fraction={support_fraction}")
else:
    first_failing_seed = next(seed for seed, result in enumerate(results) if "tau" in result and
    print(f"RESULT: FALSIFIED counterexample=\"DISJ\" first_failing_seed={first_failing_seed}")

if __name__ == "__main__":
    import sys
    seeds = [int(seed) for seed in sys.argv[1:]] or [2, 3, 5, 7, 11, 13, 17, 19, 23, 29, 31, 37, 41]
    for seed in seeds:
        result = run_trial(seed)
        print(f"TRIAL: {result}")

```

6. Per-seed results

(no seed-level data — test crashed before producing TRIAL: lines)

7. Test stdout (last 2KB)

```

--STDERR--
Traceback (most recent call last):
  File "/home/ludo/Scrivania/SEC/research/pvsnp_sandbox/test_2c561438.py", line 198, in <module>
    result = run_trial(seed)
              ~~~~~^
  File "/home/ludo/Scrivania/SEC/research/pvsnp_sandbox/test_2c561438.py", line 164, in run_trial
    results.append(run_disj_trial(n))
                   ~~~~~^
  File "/home/ludo/Scrivania/SEC/research/pvsnp_sandbox/test_2c561438.py", line 124, in run_disj_trial
    tau = bridge_invariant(M)
          ~~~~~^
  File "/home/ludo/Scrivania/SEC/research/pvsnp_sandbox/test_2c561438.py", line 72, in bridge_invariant
    sr = stable_rank(M)
         ~~~~~^
  File "/home/ludo/Scrivania/SEC/research/pvsnp_sandbox/test_2c561438.py", line 66, in stable_rank
    eigenvector = power_iteration(B)
                  ~~~~~^
  File "/home/ludo/Scrivania/SEC/research/pvsnp_sandbox/test_2c561438.py", line 38, in power_iteration
    v /= frobenius_norm(v)
        ~~~~~^
  File "/home/ludo/Scrivania/SEC/research/pvsnp_sandbox/test_2c561438.py", line 34, in frobenius_norm
    return math.sqrt(sum(sum(x**2 for x in row) for row in matrix))
                       ~~~~~^
  File "/home/ludo/Scrivania/SEC/research/pvsnp_sandbox/test_2c561438.py", line 34, in <genexpr>
    return math.sqrt(sum(sum(x**2 for x in row) for row in matrix))
                       ~~~~~^
TypeError: 'float' object is not iterable

```

8. Critic adversarial review

Critic verdict: CHALLENGE

Critic reasoning:

skipped: test crashed before producing data

9. Final verdict & safety rail

Verdict: INCONCLUSIVE

Reasoning:

The test crashed with a `TypeError` in the `power_iteration` helper (`frobenius_norm` was called on a vector treated as a matrix), so no data was produced and the pre-registered support condition cannot be evaluated. | next: Fix the `power_iteration/frobenius_norm` bug (handle 1D vectors separately, or just use `numpy.linalg.svd` for the operator norm) and re-run the full DISJ + random + Hadamard/IP_2 battery.

11. Audit log (LLM calls)

Total LLM calls: 9

#	Phase	Provider	Model	Tokens in	out	Latency (ms)
1	propose	claude_max	opus	0	0	556317
2	preregistration	claude_max	opus	0	0	8816
3	novelty	claude_max	opus	0	0	3268
4	novelty	claude_max	opus	0	0	8782
5	test_gen	ollama_remote	qwen2.5-coder:7b	0	0	27789
6	test_gen	ollama_remote	qwen2.5-coder:7b	0	0	25036
7	test_gen	ollama_remote	qwen2.5-coder:7b	0	0	36428
8	test_gen	ollama_remote	qwen2.5-coder:7b	0	0	28762
9	judge	claude_max	opus	0	0	4204

Totals: 0 input tokens, 0 output tokens, ~\$0.0000 cost, 699403 ms total latency. Provider mix: {'claude_max': 5, 'ollama_remote': 4}

(full prompt+response transcripts available in `research/audit/9b585cab1475.jsonl`)

12. Reproducibility

To reproduce this cycle:

1. Apply the test harness in section 5.1 with seeds 11,23,37,53,71
2. The Python sandbox is pure-stdlib; any Python 3.11+ should suffice
3. The full LLM transcripts are in `research/audit/9b585cab1475.jsonl` for verification of provenance
4. The pre-registration hash in section 2 commits to the test design before execution; tampering would be detectable.

Sandbox file: `research/pvsnp_sandbox/test_*.py` (per-cycle)

Replay tarball: `research/replay/9b585cab1475.tar.gz` (if generated)